

Internet/e-Commerce

Travel Survey: Summer Travel intentions stronger y/y despite ME conflict headlines

Industry Overview

Spring Online travel survey

We conducted a survey of 1,000+ U.S. consumers ages 18+ to measure online travel agency (OTA) usage and intentions. We note that our annual survey was conducted in April, well after the start of the Middle East conflict. Also, household income skewed higher in our 1Q26 survey, with fewer sub-\$50k respondents and more \$100k+ households vs our 1Q25 survey, which may have impacted results. Our top takeaways:

- US travel intentions remain healthy and improved vs. last year: 47% of respondents expect to travel more than usual over the next 12 months (vs. 43% in 1Q25). In addition, 81% plan to travel the same or more in Summer 2026 vs. Summer 2025, with ~30% planning to travel significantly more (vs. ~20% last year).
- Higher fares (fuel cost pass through) can impact travel: when asked on higher air fares and hotel rates, around 30% indicated they could postpone vacation plans if prices increased, and 24% indicated they could travel locally vs taking a flight.
- AI adoption accelerating: 44% have used ChatGPT/Gemini/Claude for travel planning, up from 18% in 1Q25. Also, 40% have used Booking or Expedia's AI chatbot (vs 26% in 1Q25). 38% indicated they would use an AI agent to autonomously book travel, while 30% are interested but not yet comfortable.
- OTA engagement and intent to book on an OTA improved y/y across major platforms, with Booking and Airbnb having biggest y/y gains. Use of Booking's Genius program increased significantly y/y, while Expedia's One Key was relatively stable y/y. Also, respondents increased usage of hotel direct loyalty programs.
- Hotels remain the preferred accommodation choice, but a lower 60% (down vs 64% LY) favor hotels vs 25% preferring alternative accommodations (AA), while 15% indicated no strong preference. Within AA, Airbnb and Booking.com gained share.
- OTAs continue gain ground vs Google in use for accommodation search, with Expedia overtaking Google as top preference for "to search for hotels or accommodations" and Booking.com gaining share. However, in a separate question respondents indicated increasing use of Google as a travel starting point vs OTAs.
- For corporate travel, among those using a platform for bookings, Amex GBT (incl. Egencia) had leading share at ~23%, while ~18% use Navan.

Sector and Company Level Takeaways

We view the survey results as positive constructive for US travel this Summer. **Booking**, gained ground as travel starting point, and had loyalty usage and AA share uptick. For **Expedia**, survey was mixed, with Expedia usage growing and more accommodation search, but reported Vrbo usage fell among AA sites. For **Airbnb**, survey data was also mixed, with improving AA category indicators (usage and willingness to list) but a modest decline in Airbnb's share vs 1Q25 for top AA site used. From here, while NT travel bookings may be sensitive to air fares, we think overall survey data and other [travel metrics \(report\)](#) point to strong U.S. travel activity, which we think is most constructive for Expedia (60% US) and then Airbnb (44% NA bookings in 2025) given business mix.

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AA: Alternative Accommodation

OTA: Online Travel Agency

STR: Short Term Rental

LTM: Last 12 months

ME: Middle East

NA: North America

Travel survey: travel intentions holding up

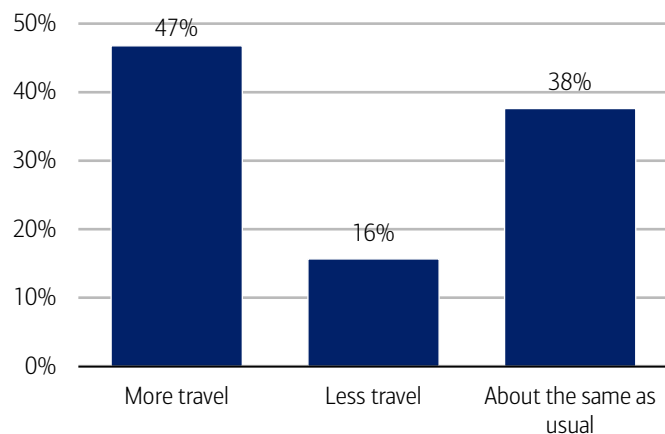
We surveyed ~1,000 people in the US in April 2026 on their travel behavior and preferences. We note that our survey was conducted during the ongoing Middle-East tensions. Responses to our survey are outlined below:

Intention to travel higher this year

The results of our recent Travel Survey indicate expectations for healthy travel activity this year, and more travel vs 2025. Around 47% (vs 43% in 1Q25 survey) our survey respondents expect to travel more than usual over the next 12 months. Also, 81% (similar to 1Q25 survey) indicated that they plan to travel the same or more in Summer 2026 vs 2025. Among those, 30% indicated that they plan to travel “significantly more” than last year Summer (vs. 20% in our 2025 survey).

Exhibit 1: 47% respondents expect to travel more than usual in the next 12 months

Do you expect to travel more than usual over the next 12 months?

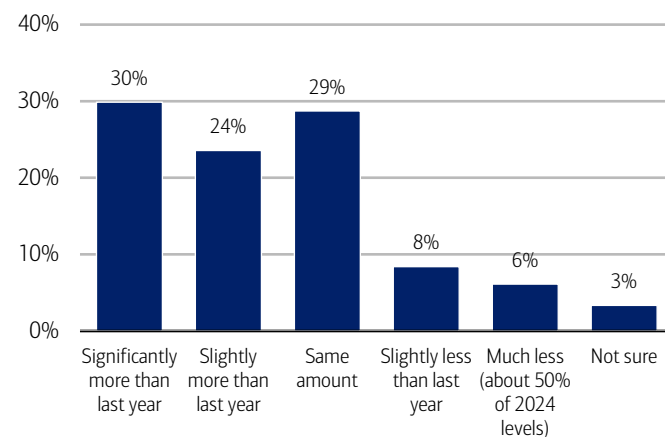


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1048

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Exhibit 2: Respondents plan to travel more in Summer 2026 vs 2025

How much do you think you will travel in Summer 2026 (compared to Summer 2025)?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1048

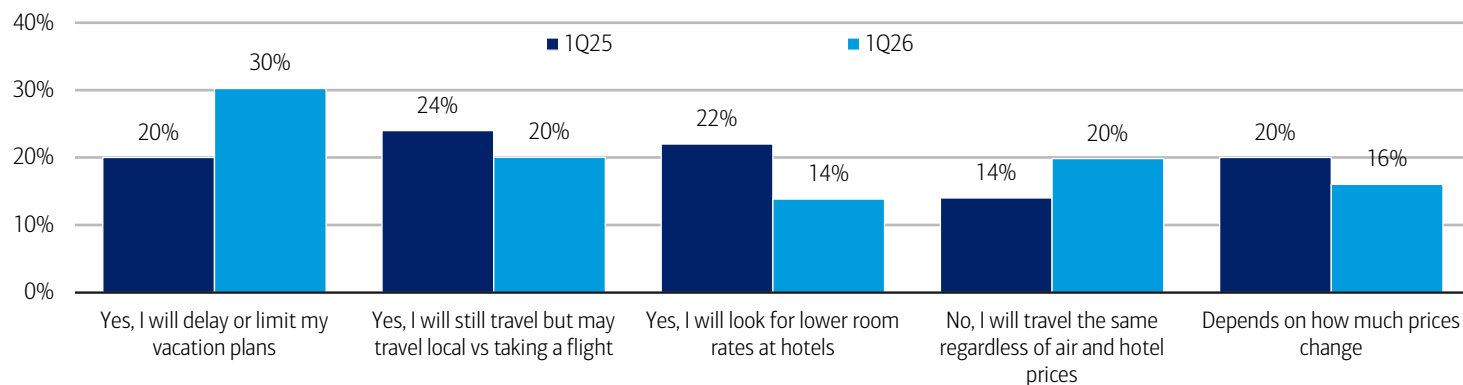
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Higher fares could impact travel choices

When asked about inflation, 64% of the survey respondents believe that higher flight prices and hotel room rates would impact their travel choices. Around 30% could postpone vacation plans, about 20% respondents said that higher rates could cause them to travel local (vs taking a flight), and 14% said they will look for lower room rates at hotels.

Exhibit 3: Respondents could delay/limit travel activity if travel prices increase y/y

Will costlier flights and hotel room rates impact your leisure travel plans in 2026?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1048

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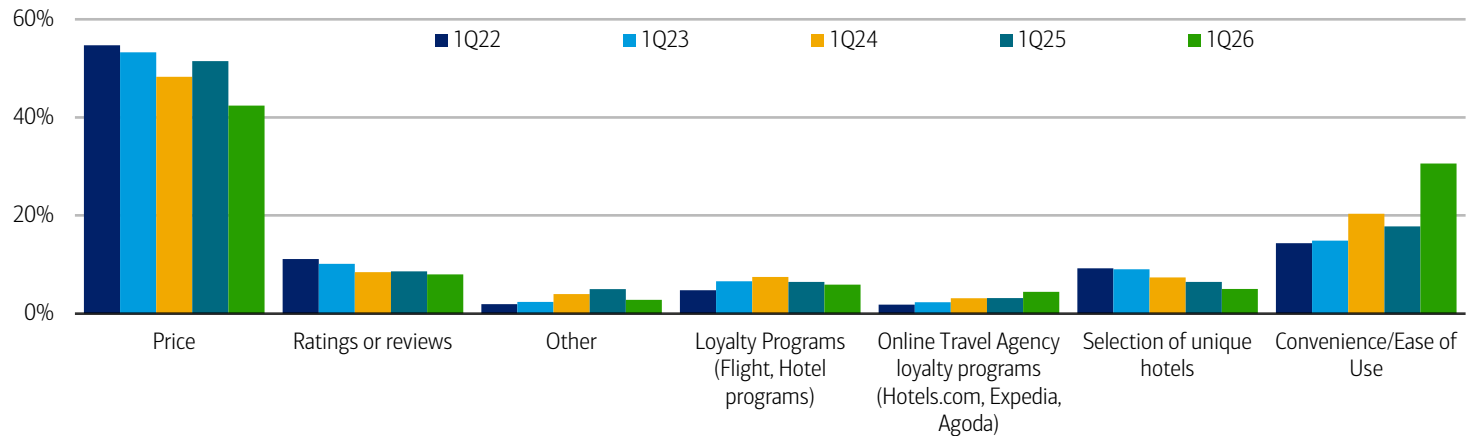


Price remains most important for travel bookings

We asked what “the most important factor when making online travel bookings” and compared it to prior surveys below. Price remains the most important factor for respondents, but its importance reduced while the significance of “convenience” increased vs 1Q25.

Exhibit 4: What is the most important factor when making online travel bookings?

Price remains the most important factor (up vs last year)



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1043

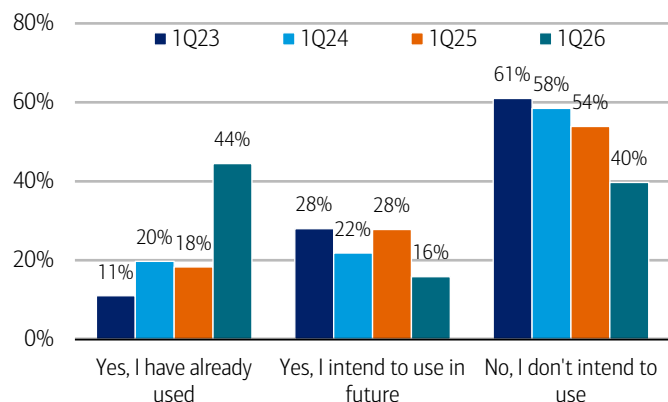
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Increasing usage of AI-driven chatbots

There was a sharp increase in respondents indicating use of AI platforms for travel planning. Around 60% of users indicated previous use or intention to use Chat GPT for their travel planning needs vs 46% in 1Q25 survey. Among them, around 44% respondents have already used Chat GPT for travel planning vs 18% in 1Q25 survey. Around 40% of respondents have also used Booking.com or Expedia’s chatbot for travel planning and another 20% plan to use, suggesting slightly slower uptake of embedded AI tools within OTAs vs standalone generative AI solutions. Overall, close to 60% of respondents have used or intend to use Booking.com or Expedia’s chatbot (vs 53% in 1Q25 survey).

Exhibit 5: About 60% respondents have used or intend to use Chat GPT/Gemini/Claude for travel planning (vs 46% in 1Q25 survey)

Have you used ChatGPT/Gemini/Claude for travel planning?

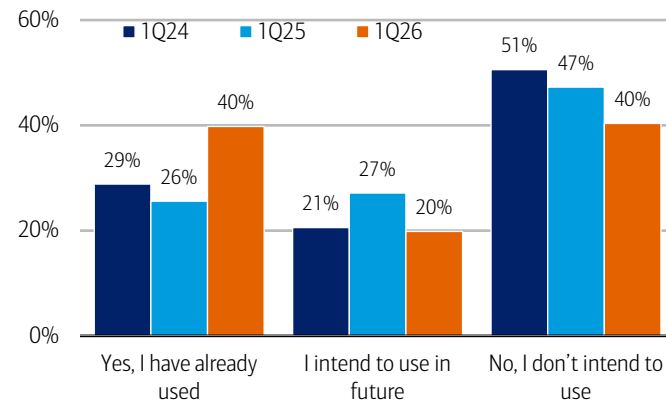


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1048

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Exhibit 6: Around 60% of respondents have used or intend to use Booking.com or Expedia's chatbot (vs 53% in 1Q25 survey)

Have you used Booking or Expedia's chatbot for travel planning?



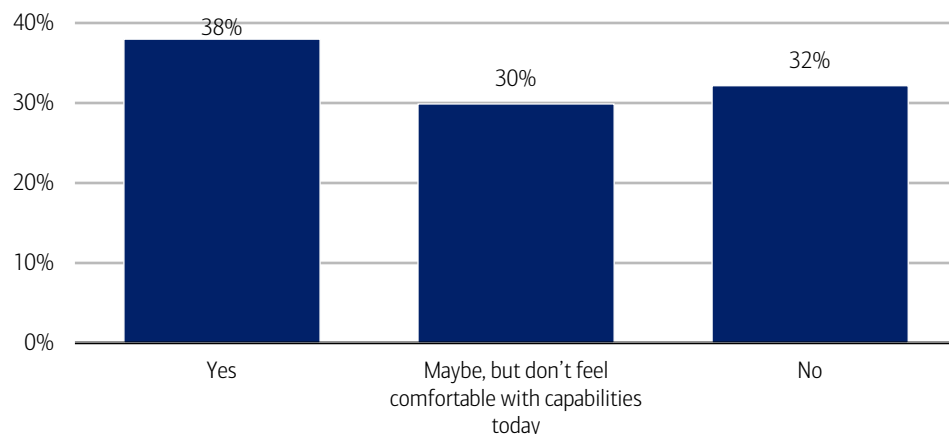
Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1048

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Respondents indicated mixed comfort with using AI agents to autonomously book travel. About 38% of respondents say they would use an AI agent today, while 30% are interested but not yet comfortable with current capabilities. Another 32% indicate they would not use an AI agent for this purpose, highlighting both meaningful early adoption and remaining adoption barriers.

Exhibit 7: Around 38% respondents would use an AI agent to autonomously book their travel

Would you use an AI agent to autonomously book your travel?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1048

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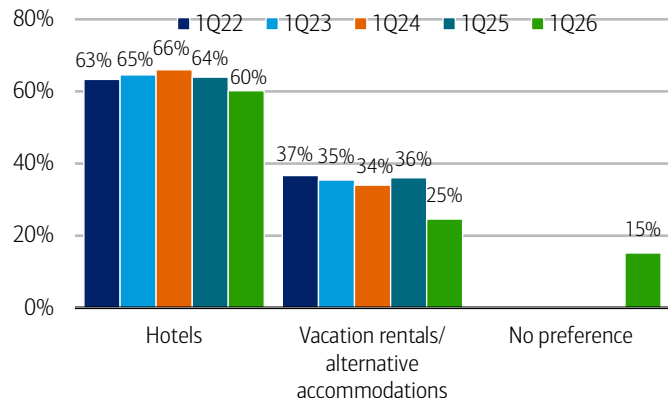
Hotel preference stickier vs. Alternative Accommodations

Among our respondents, 60% indicated they prefer to stay at hotels vs. 25% that prefer vacation rentals/alternative accommodations (the rest 15% indicated that they have no preference between Hotels vs AA, a new option choice in this survey). Alternative accommodations preference was more impacted by respondents switching to "No preference". When sorted by age group, we have found that Alternative Accommodations are most preferred by younger cohorts.



Exhibit 8: Do you prefer to stay at Hotels or vacation rentals/ alternative accommodations (like Airbnb)?

60% prefer to stay at hotels vs. 25% prefer alternative accommodations, and 15% have “no preference” between the two

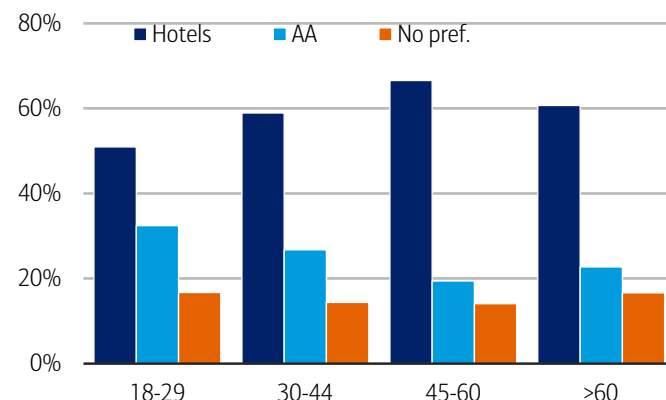


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1040

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Exhibit 9: Alternative Accommodations are most preferred by younger cohorts

Do you prefer to stay at Hotels or vacation rentals/ alternative accommodations (like Airbnb)?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1024

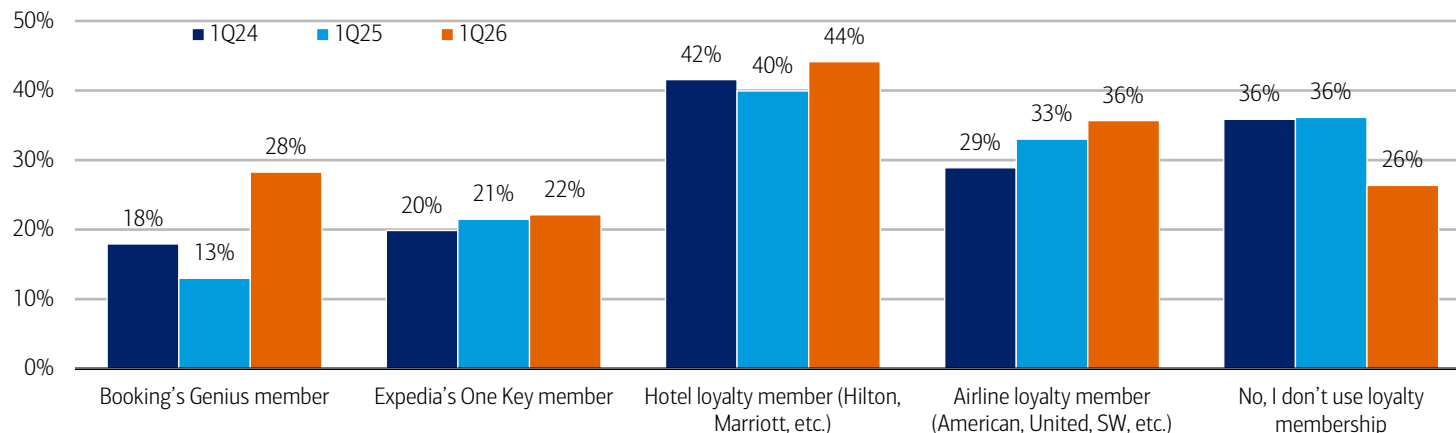
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Loyalty programs picking pace; Hotel loyalty most popular

Among our survey respondents, Hotel loyalty programs were the most used with 44% opting for those (up vs 40% in our 1Q25 survey). About 28% were members of Booking’s Genius program, a meaningful uptick from 13% in our previous survey. Expedia’s loyalty program (now One Key) had slightly better adoption at 22% vs 21% in 1Q25 survey. Around 26% of respondents weren’t part of any loyalty membership program, lower vs 36% in our previous survey.

Exhibit 10: Which loyalty program are you a member of?

Hotel loyalty programs were the most popular with 40% adoption



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1024

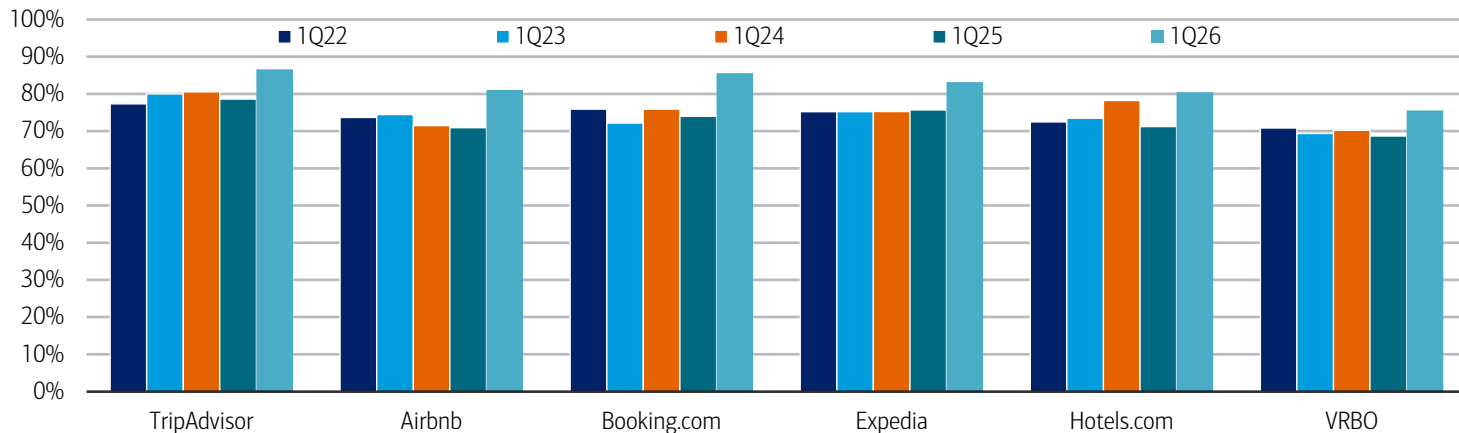
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Reported OTAs usage has seen modest uptick

Reported usage of all OTAs had y/y improvement, with Airbnb and Booking.com up the most vs our 2025 survey. Those that indicated decreased/stopped using OTAs were also lower across the online travel platforms (vs our 1Q25 survey).

Exhibit 11: How has your usage of the following sites changed over the last 6 months? (Increased/Stayed the same)

Reported usage of OTAs increased vs 2025, with Airbnb and Booking.com seeing biggest increases

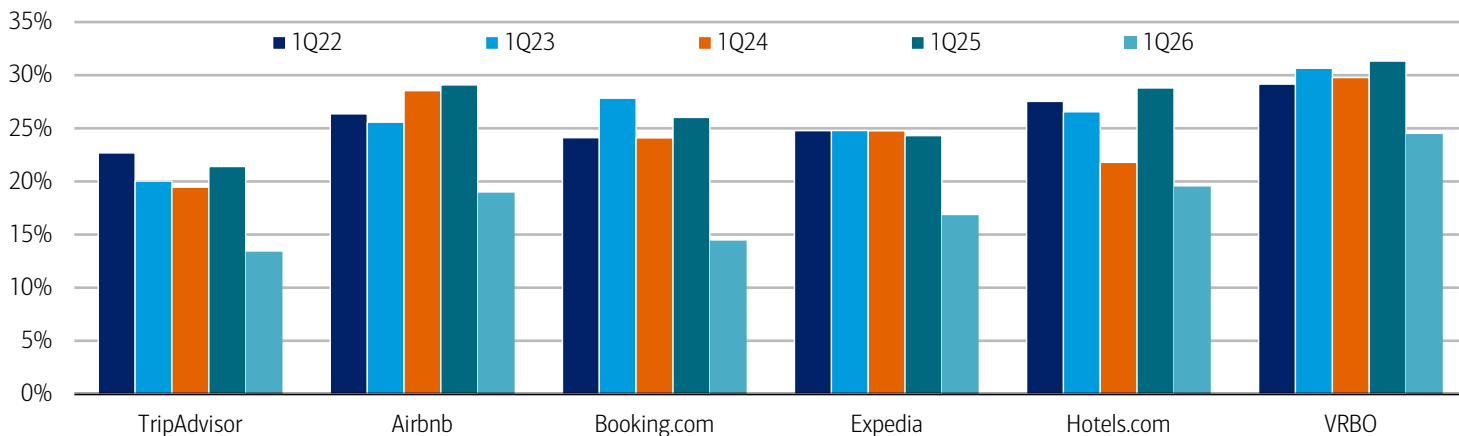


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1040

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Exhibit 12: How has your usage of the following sites changed over the last 6 months? (Decreased/Stopped using)

Responses that indicated decreased/stopped using Expedia were also slightly lower (vs our 1Q24 survey)



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1040

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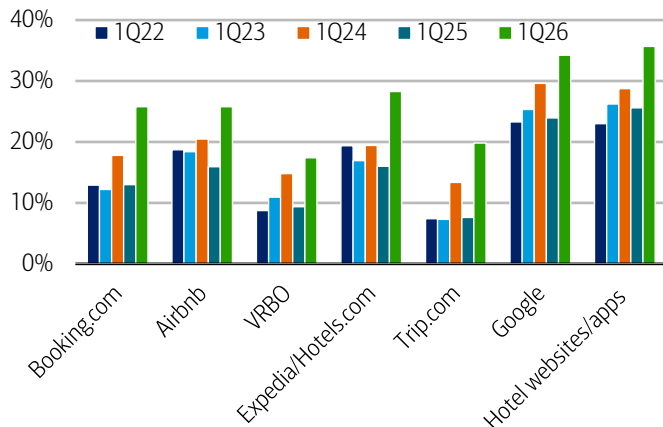
Intention to book improving across sector

The percent of respondents “very likely” to book accommodation was up vs 1Q25 for most major OTAs, while “very unlikely” to book on OTAs decreased. “Very unlikely” to book on Google and direct hotel websites has also declined vs 1Q25 survey. Overall, we see this data suggesting stronger demand trends vs 2025, consistent with our Intention to travel question results.



Exhibit 13: Respondents “very likely” to book accommodation has increased across platforms

How likely are you to use one of the following to book your next vacation accommodation? – “very likely”

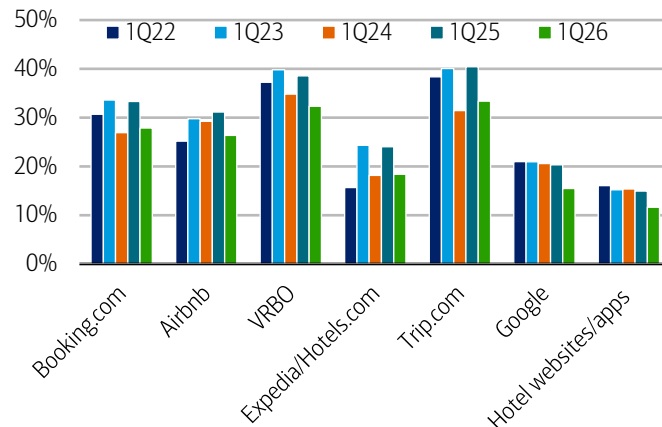


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1024

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Exhibit 14: The percent of respondents “very unlikely” to book accommodation has decreased across platforms

How likely are you to use one of the following to book your next vacation accommodation? – “very unlikely”



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1024

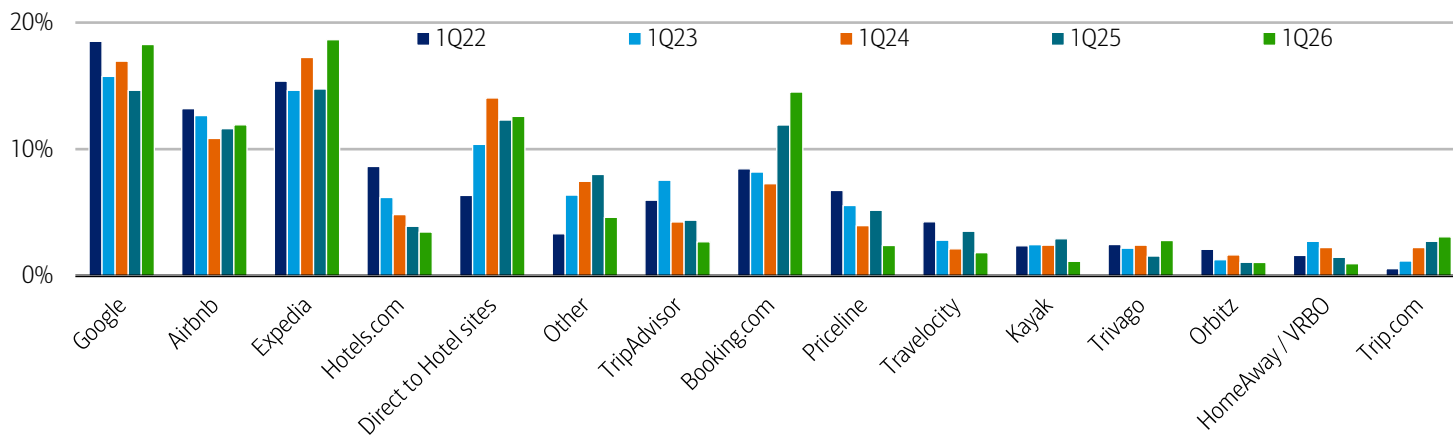
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OTAs improving for accommodation search

In prior surveys Google has been the most widely used site “to search for hotels or accommodations”, but Expedia at 19% was higher vs Google at 18% in this survey. Respondents choosing Booking.com also increased to 15% from 12%, while Airbnb was steady at 12% vs 1Q25 survey. Reported use of direct to hotel sites slightly increased to 13% vs 12% in our 1Q25 survey.

Exhibit 15: Expedia “most popular” for search usage, and Booking.com usage has also gone up meaningfully y/y

Which website do you use most often to search for hotels or accommodation?



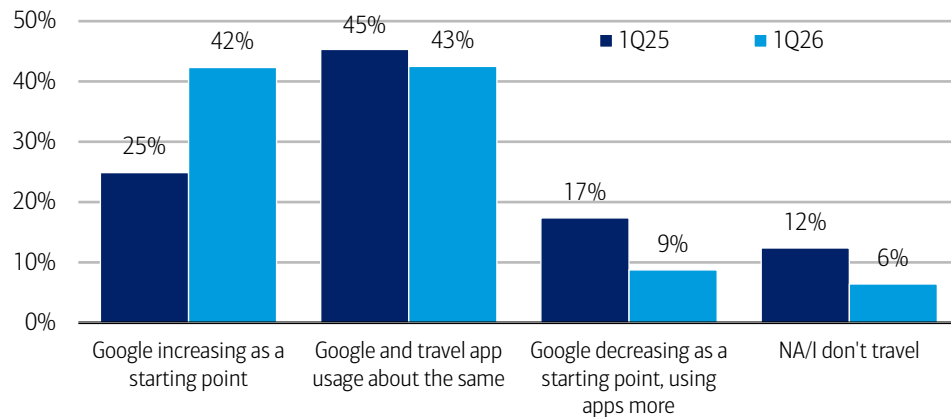
Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1024

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When ask about usage of Google versus “going direct to travel apps”, about 42% of respondents said their usage of Google as a starting point is increasing (vs 25% in our previous survey), and 43% said Google and travel app usage is about the same.

Exhibit 16: 42% responded with increasing usage for Google vs direct to travel apps

Is your usage of Google for travel planning increasing or decreasing vs going direct to travel apps?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1040

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Experience bookings going more online

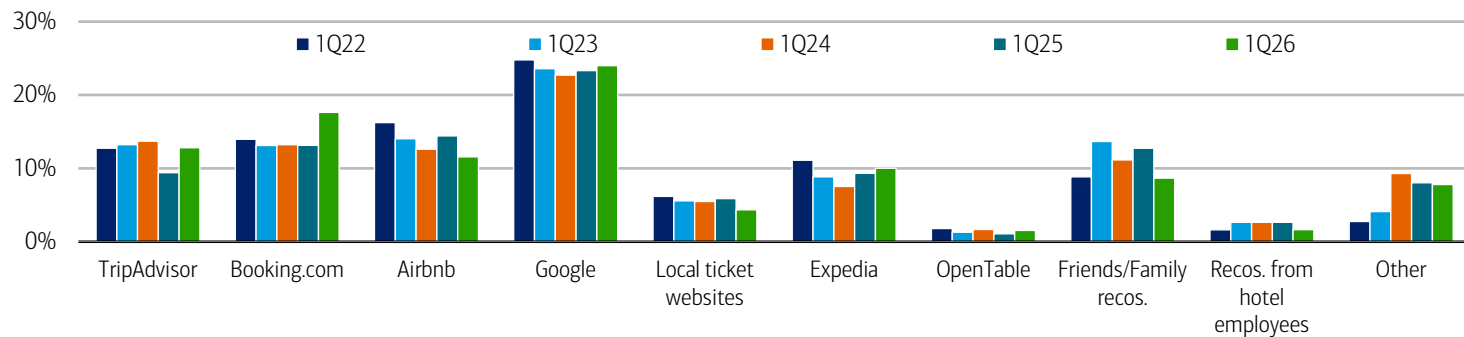
We asked a question on experiences and activities bookings given full trip initiatives at Airbnb and Bookings.

Google's popularity for planning or booking activities during the trip was slightly up vs 1Q25 (as was Tripadvisor, Booking and Expedia). Airbnb's popularity among respondents was lower vs our 1Q25 survey, underscoring still limited rollout of the services offering.

Usage of other channels, like local ticket websites, family/friend recommendations, recommendations from hotel employees declined vs our 1Q25 survey.

Exhibit 17: For Experiences, usage of Booking increased the most

Which of the following are you most likely to use when planning or booking activities and experiences during your trip?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1024

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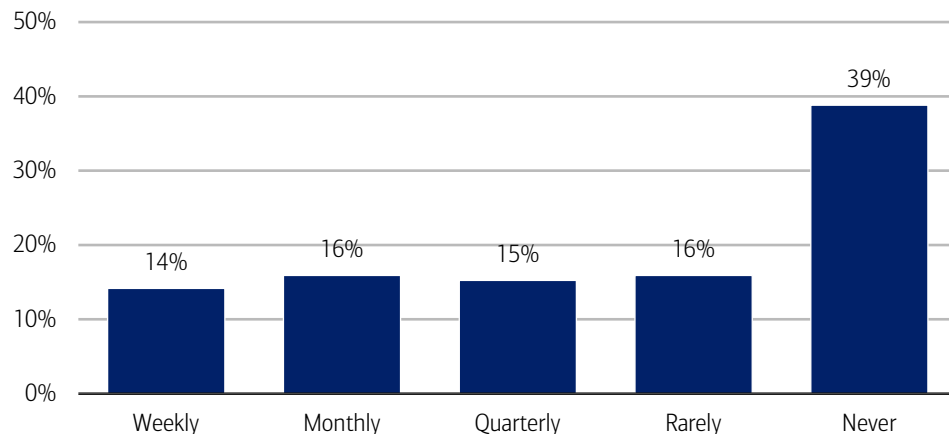


Corporate travel frequency and platform adoption is low

Around 55% of our survey respondents indicated that they never or rarely travel for business. 45% travel for business either weekly, monthly or quarterly.

Exhibit 18: 39% of survey respondents “never” travel for business

How often does your job require you to travel for business?



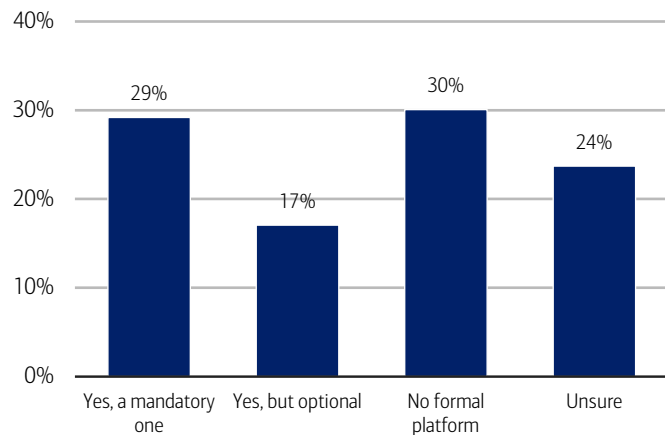
Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1038

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While 29% of respondents report that their company mandates use of a managed platform, a similar share (30%) say their company has no formal platform at all. An additional 24% are unsure whether such a platform exists, suggesting meaningful gaps in communication or adoption. Among respondents, 23% primarily use Amex GBT (includes 6% respondents using Egencia) and 18% use Navan (formerly TripActions).

Exhibit 19: Most survey respondents don't know or don't use a corporate travel platform to book business travel

Does your company use a managed travel platform?

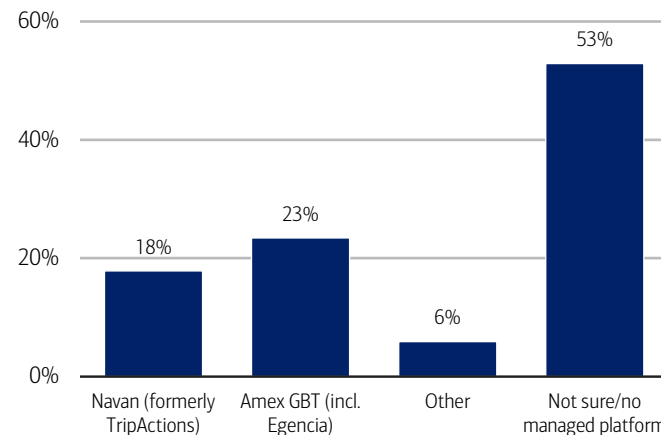


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1038

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Exhibit 20: Among respondents, 23% use Amex GBT (including 6% for Egencia) and 18% use Navan for corporate travel needs

Which corporate travel platform does your company primarily use?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1038

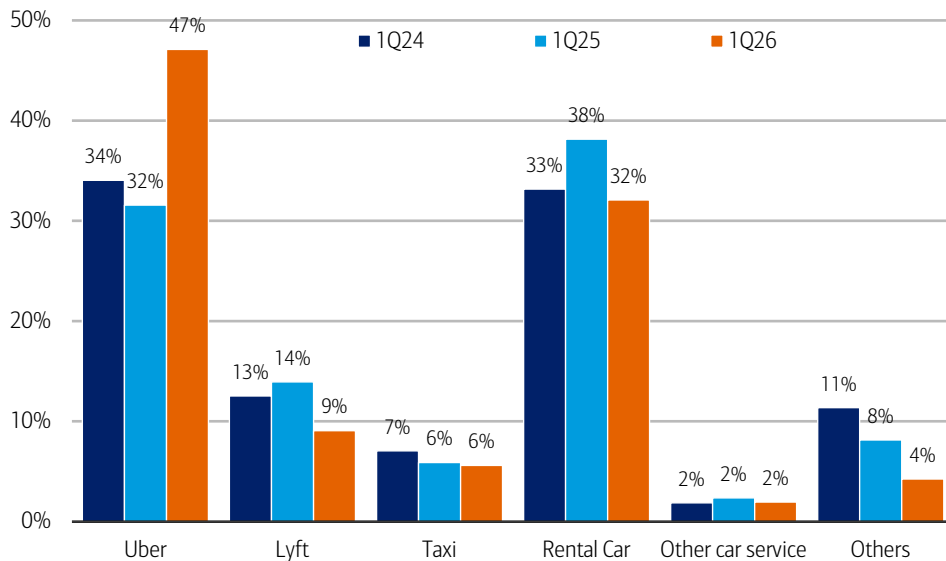
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Rental car usage for transportation up, Uber down slightly

Respondents preferring Uber for ground transportation during a trip increased to 47% vs 32% in our 1Q25 survey, while those that chose rental cars fell to 32% vs 38% in our 1Q25 survey.

Exhibit 21: Uber usage up y/y; Rental car and Lyft was down

Which service would you mostly likely use for ground transportation on a trip?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1038

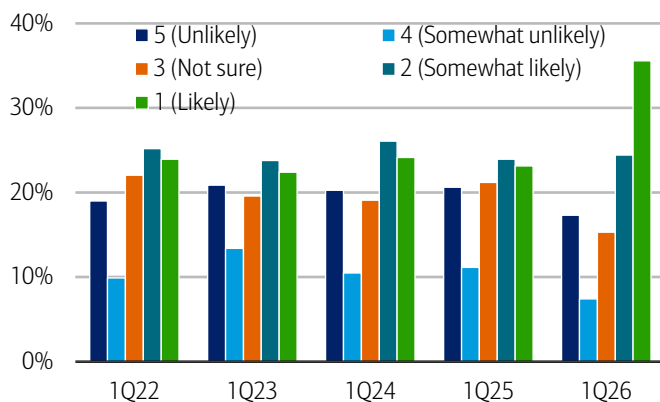
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Alternate Accommodations penetration improving

Among our respondents, the percentage of people willing to stay at another person's home was higher vs our 1Q25 survey, at 36% vs 23% last year. Also, the percent of respondents **unwilling** to list their properties for Short-term rentals (STR) has decreased vs 1Q25. Around 30% of respondents suggested that they list their house or apartment on AA sites (up vs 13% in 1Q25), while 15% indicated that they may list their house on AA sites in the future, slightly down from 16% in 1Q25.

Exhibit 22: An increasing percent of travelers willing to stay in an AA

How willing are you to book a stay in another person's home (Airbnb, VRBO, HomeAway, Booking.com)?

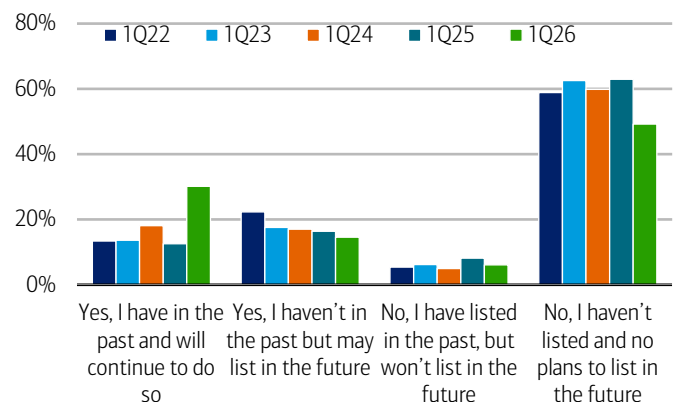


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1024

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Exhibit 23: More respondents willing to list their house for rental

Would you be willing to list your house or apartment for a short-term rental on Airbnb, VRBO, or other alternative accommodation site?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1020

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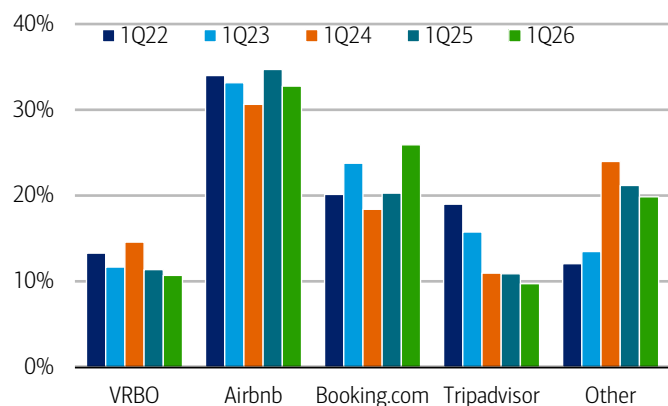
Booking gained ground for AA usage, still trails Airbnb

Airbnb was still the top used alternative accommodation site used by our respondents at 33%, (down from vs 35% in 1Q25 survey), compared to Booking at 26% (up vs 20% last year) and Expedia's VRBO steady at 11%. "Other" alternative accommodation sites decreased in popularity y/y. "Other" sites could include local property management companies.

Top reasons why respondents might prefer AA over hotels were pricing (54%), followed by comfort (42%). "I don't prefer AA to hotels" fell slightly y/y.

Exhibit 24: Airbnb was the top alternative accommodation site

What are top alternative accommodation sites you use?

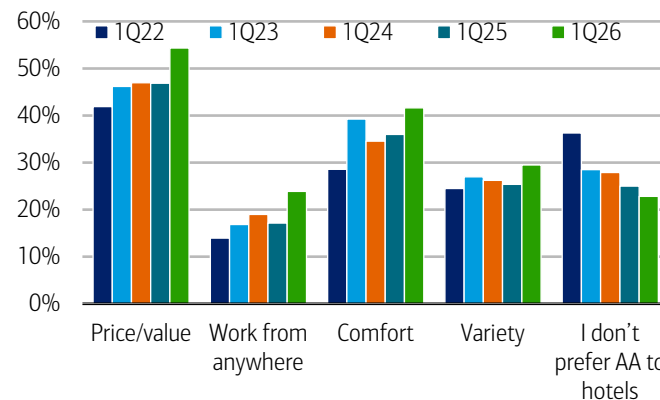


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1020

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Exhibit 25: Pricing (54%), followed by comfort (42%) were the top reasons to prefer AAs

Why do you prefer Alternative Accommodations (i.e. Airbnb or VRBO) over hotels?



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1020

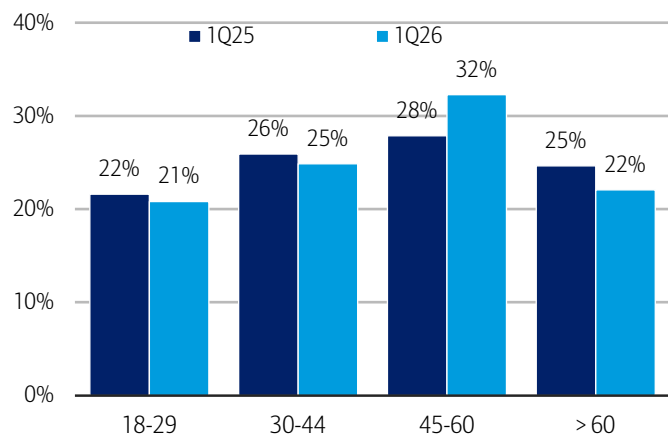
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Survey respondent's demographics

Relative to 1Q25, the 1Q26 survey sample skews modestly older and higher income. The age mix shifts toward the 45-60 cohort, which gains share and becomes the largest demographic, while participation from younger respondents and those over 60 trends slightly lower. In parallel, the household income distribution tilts up-market, with a reduced concentration in sub-\$50k brackets and increased representation among \$100k+ households, resulting in a higher-income respondent base in 1Q26.

Exhibit 26: Age distribution

Healthy age mix among our survey respondents

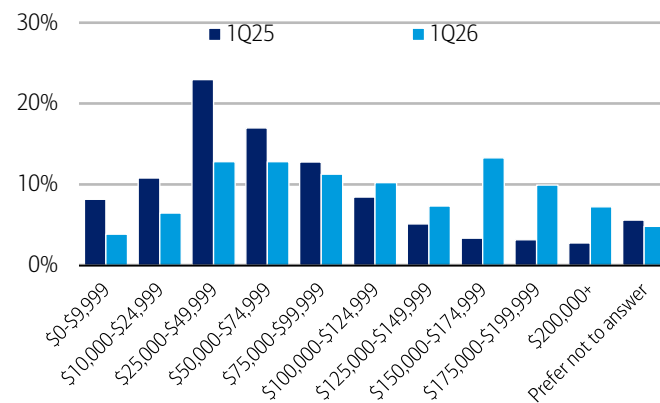


Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1038

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Exhibit 27: Household income distribution

Healthy income distribution among our survey respondents



Source: BofA Global Research, Survey Monkey, n=1038

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Exhibit 28: Stocks mentioned

Prices and ratings for stocks mentioned in this report

BofA Ticker	Bloomberg ticker	Company name	Price	Rating
ABNB	ABNB US	Airbnb	US\$ 137.05	B-2-9
BKNG	BKNG US	Booking Holdings	US\$ 157.8	B-1-7
EXPE	EXPE US	Expedia	US\$ 221.46	C-1-7

Source: BofA Global Research

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Price objective basis & risk

Airbnb (ABNB)

Our \$150 price objective is based on 15x 2027E EBITDA (representing 14x 2027 FCF). This multiple is at the higher end of our Marketplace comp group range reflects strong direct traffic, alternative accommodation category leadership, new growth opportunities, and significantly higher margins and FCF generation than marketplace peers.

Risks are: 1) multiple compression given high relative valuation, 2) potential for increased competition for incremental bookings driving up marketing spend, 3) decelerating room night growth from higher penetration, and 4) regulatory limitations on market growth.

Booking Holdings Inc (BKNG)

Our price objective is \$235, based on 19x our 2027E EPS, which compares to Booking's 10-year historical range of 10-24x. We think a forward P/E multiple premium to OTA peers is appropriate given higher quality of earnings, market share growth and strong FCF generation.

Risks to our PO are: 1) a global economic downturn or Global conflicts that reduce travel activity, 2) competition for traffic from Google lowering growth or margins, 3) hotels favoring their own distribution channels, 4) FX volatility, and 5) increased direct traffic competition from Agentic booking channels. The stock has been subject to heavy volatility in the past based on travel disruptions and this volatility could increase given rapid rate of AI transformation in the industry.

Expedia (EXPE)

Our \$310 PO is based on a 50-50 blend of P/E and sum-of-the-parts valuations based on 2027 estimates. Our EV/EBITDA valuation is based on a 8x EBITDA , and our P/E valuation is based on 15x GAAP EPS. Our P/E multiple is within Expedia's historical ranges of forward EPS and a discount compared to Booking valuation given market share trends.

Downside risks to our PO are: 1) economic downturn or prolonged macro headwinds leading to fewer travel bookings, 2) competition for traffic lowering the company's growth or margin opportunity, 3) more aggressive direct booking initiatives by hotels, and 4) Google Agentic traffic disintermediation.

Analyst Certification

We, Justin Post and Nafeesa Gupta, hereby certify that the views each of us has expressed in this research report accurately reflect each of our respective personal views about the subject securities and issuers. We also certify that no part of our respective compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or view expressed in this research report.



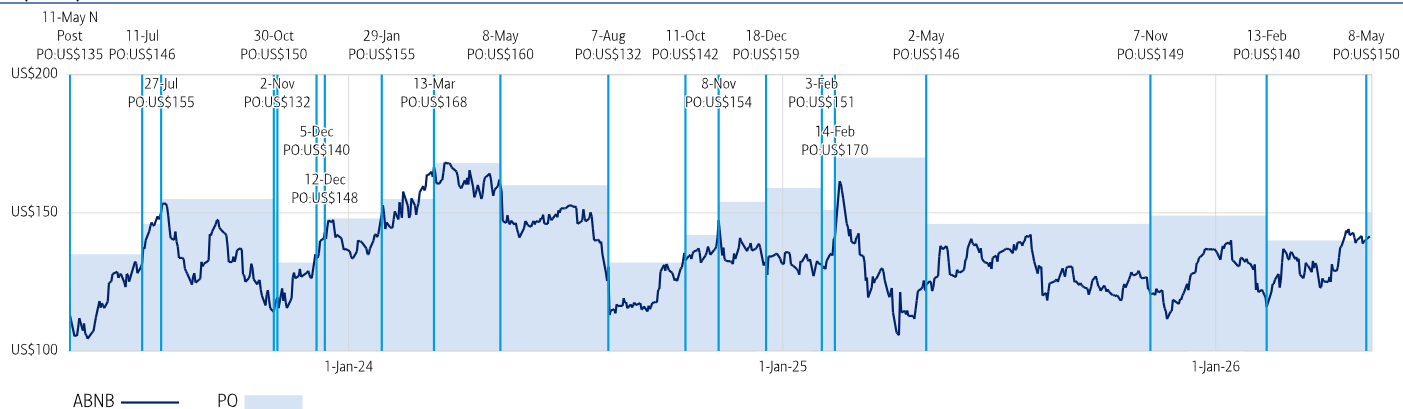
US - Internet Coverage Cluster

Investment rating	Company	BofA Ticker	Bloomberg symbol	Analyst
BUY				
	Alphabet	GOOGL	GOOGL US	Justin Post
	Alphabet	GOOG	GOOG US	Justin Post
	Amazon.com	AMZN	AMZN US	Justin Post
	AppLovin	APP	APP US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Booking Holdings Inc	BKNG	BKNG US	Justin Post
	Chewy Inc	CHWY	CHWY US	Michael McGovern
	DoorDash	DASH	DASH US	Justin Post
	DoubleVerify Holdings, Inc.	DV	DV US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Ethos	LIFE	LIFE US	Michael McGovern
	Expedia	EXPE	EXPE US	Justin Post
	LegalZoom	LZ	LZ US	Michael McGovern
	Life360	LIF	LIF US	Nitin Bansal, CFA
	Magnite, Inc.	MGNI	MGNI US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Meta Platforms Inc	META	META US	Justin Post
	Navan, Inc.	NAVN	NAVN US	Nafeesa Gupta
	Peloton	PTON	PTON US	Nafeesa Gupta
	Playtika	PLTK	PLTK US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Take-Two Interactive	TTWO	TTWO US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Tripadvisor	TRIP	TRIP US	Nafeesa Gupta
	Uber	UBER	UBER US	Justin Post
	Wayfair	W	W US	Michael McGovern
	Wix.com	WIX	WIX US	Michael McGovern
NEUTRAL				
	Airbnb	ABNB	ABNB US	Justin Post
	Carvana	CVNA	CVNA US	Michael McGovern
	Coursera Inc.	COUR	COUR US	Nafeesa Gupta
	Digital Turbine, Inc	APPS	APPS US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Duolingo	DUOL	DUOL US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	eBay	EBAY	EBAY US	Michael McGovern
	Etsy, Inc.	ETSY	ETSY US	Michael McGovern
	Instacart	CART	CART US	Justin Post
	Match Group	MTCH	MTCH US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Pinterest	PINS	PINS US	Justin Post
	Reddit	RDDT	RDDT US	Justin Post
	Roblox Corp. Class A	RBLX	RBLX US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Snap	SNAP	SNAP US	Justin Post
	StubHub Holdings	STUB	STUB US	Justin Post
	Unity	U	U US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Vivid Seats	SEAT	SEAT US	Steven McDermott
	Zillow	Z	Z US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Zillow Group	ZG	ZG US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
UNDERPERFORM				
	ACV Auctions	ACVA	ACVA US	Michael McGovern
	Bumble	BMBL	BMBL US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Cardlytics, Inc	CDLX	CDLX US	Omar Dessouky, CFA
	Ibotta	IBTA	IBTA US	Nitin Bansal, CFA
	Lyft, Inc.	LYFT	LYFT US	Justin Post
	Yelp	YELP	YELP US	Nitin Bansal, CFA
RSTR				
	Global Business Travel Group, Inc.	GBTG	GBTG US	Nafeesa Gupta

Disclosures

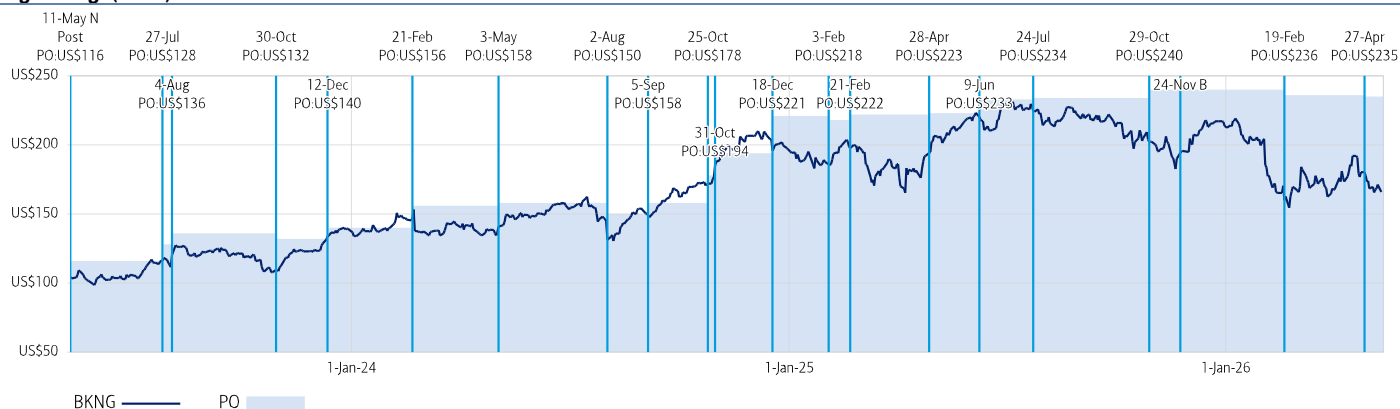
Important Disclosures



Airbnb (ABNB) Price Chart

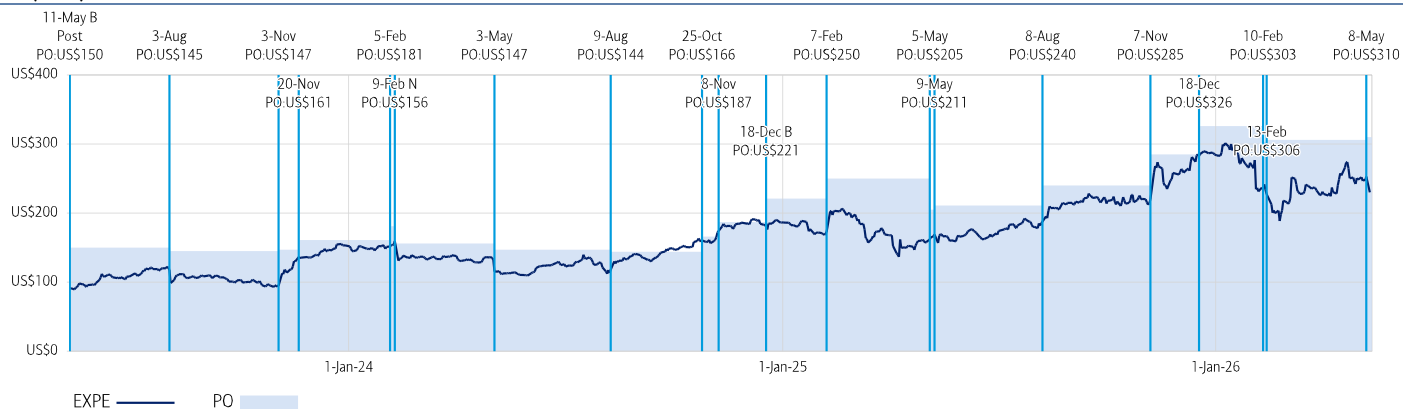
B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

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Booking Holdings (BKNG) Price Chart

B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

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Expedia (EXPE) Price Chart

B: Buy, N: Neutral, U: Underperform, PO: Price Objective, NA: No longer valid, NR: No Rating

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Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Technology Group (as of 31 Mar 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	234	58.50%	Buy	123	52.56%
Hold	90	22.50%	Hold	43	47.78%
Sell	76	19.00%	Sell	23	30.26%

Equity Investment Rating Distribution: Global Group (as of 31 Mar 2026)

Coverage Universe	Count	Percent	Inv. Banking Relationships ^{R1}	Count	Percent
Buy	1993	55.76%	Buy	1186	59.51%
Hold	821	22.97%	Hold	509	62.00%
Sell	760	21.26%	Sell	400	52.63%

^{R1} Issuers that were investment banking clients of BofA Securities or one of its affiliates within the past 12 months. For purposes of this Investment Rating Distribution, the coverage universe includes only stocks. A stock rated Neutral is included as a Hold, and a stock rated Underperform is included as a Sell.

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Investment rating	Total return expectation (within 12-month period of date of initial rating)	Ratings dispersion guidelines for coverage cluster ^{R2}
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Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

^{R2} Ratings dispersions may vary from time to time where BofA Global Research believes it better reflects the investment prospects of stocks in a Coverage Cluster.

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